

THE FIRST CANADIANS

Native peoples, including the Inuit, are sometimes called Canada's "First Nations" because they lived in Canada long before European settlers arrived and took over their lands. Since 1970, the government has tried to draw these peoples into Canadian society, but many prefer their own culture and traditions. Across Canada colorful ceremonies and festivals demonstrate their proud spirit. Recently, First Nations have begun to win battles for their rights to ancestral lands. In 1999, the Nunavut area in the Northwest Territories became a self-governing Inuit territory, the first part of Canada to be governed by native Canadians in modern history.



The Inuit live in such cold conditions that they depend on warm clothing for survival.

Traditional Inuit jacket, called a parka

Insulated boots keep feet warm in freezing winter weather.



Caribou fur is used by the Inuit since it traps warm air between each of the hairs.



JAMES BAY

In 1971, construction began on a vast hydroelectric project to dam the rivers that flow into James Bay and Hudson Bay, generating electricity for use in Canada and the US. However, the project threatened thousands of Cree Indians who live in this region. An agreement was reached in 1975 that led to the finishing of the project, and special compensation for the Indians.

CANADIAN PACIFIC RAILWAY

The last spike of the transcontinental rail link of the Canadian Pacific Railway was pounded in at Eagle Pass, British Columbia, on November 7, 1885. It was the start of a new era for Canada, opening up the west for trade and settlement, and finally making the vast country seem like one nation. One of the railroad's most amazing engineering feats is a spiral tunnel-road drilled into the Rocky Mountains. Curving steadily around, the tunnel rises for more than 3,000 ft (914 m). In spite of quicker alternatives, tourists often take the spectacular trip across Canada by train. However, the railroad is mostly used for cargo.



Zinc can be galvanized onto steel to prevent it from rusting.



Nickel can be mixed with other metals to make jet engines.

MINERAL WEALTH

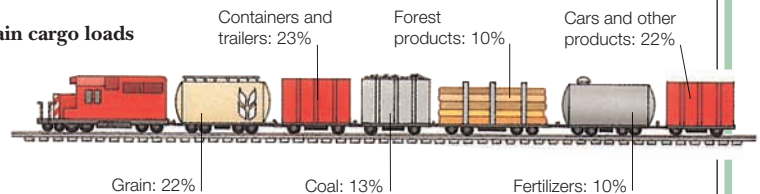
Most of Canada's wealth comes from its abundance of natural resources, many of them mineral. It is the world's largest producer of uranium, zinc, and nickel, and also has reserves of aluminum, gold, copper, and silver.

Underground work has begun on what are thought to be some of the world's richest diamond deposits in an area near Yellowknife in the Northwest Territories.



Snow plows clear the roads to make them safe.

Main cargo loads



AGRICULTURE

Wheat and cattle farming dominate Canada's main farming area, the prairies. Elsewhere, a wide variety of fruits and vegetables are grown. Apples, shown growing here in British Columbia, are the country's most important fruit crop. Between lakes Ontario and Erie lies the Niagara fruit belt. The lakes protect this area from the worst of Canada's weather, making it the ideal place for growing tender fruits such as pears, plums, peaches, and cherries.



Find out more

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